



LME KNITTING PATTERN

LME MINI & ME PONCHO FOR KIDS

SIZE 92-176

An easy-knit poncho with a low ribbed neckline and a round increase section. The whole garment is knitted in the round from the top down as one continuous piece. No splits and no seaming. The poncho finishes with a continuous i-cord edge and one fastening on each side.



By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIPS: Read the whole pattern once before you cast on. Always knit a gauge swatch first, see page 3.

BEFORE YOU START

The poncho is knitted in the round from the neckline to the hem. Eight even increase lines shape the round silhouette. After the last increase, all stitches are knitted plain in the round with no further shaping. The buttonholes are made on the back part of the same round piece, right above the hem. The buttons are sewn on the front part.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- to knit a low, soft ribbed neckline in 1 knit, 1 purl
- to knit in the round on a circular needle
- to increase evenly in eight sections
- to make a simple buttonhole on each side
- to bind off with i-cord all round the hem

HOW HARD IS IT?

Easy to a little practised. You should be able to cast on, knit and purl, and knit in the round. Increases, buttonholes and i-cord bind-off are explained step by step.

One step at a time, and in the end you have a poncho.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Air (65% alpaca, 28% polyamide, 7% wool, 50 g = approx. 150 m). The poncho is knitted with one strand.

Size	Amount	Skeins
92	200 g	4
98	200 g	4
104	200 g	4
110	200 g	4
116	250 g	5
122	250 g	5
128	250 g	5
134	300 g	6
140	300 g	6
146	300 g	6
152	300 g	6
158	300 g	6
164	350 g	7
170	350 g	7
176	350 g	7

NEEDLES AND KIT

- 4.5 mm circular needle, 40–60 cm, for the neckline
- 5 mm circular needle, 80–120 cm, for the rest of the poncho
- 8 stitch markers and 4 removable markers
- 2 flat buttons, approx. 18–25 mm
- tapestry needle and tape measure

GAUGE

17 stitches and 22 rows in stockinette = 10 × 10 cm on 5 mm needles after washing and drying. Knit a swatch. Change needle size if your gauge does not match.

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

WHICH SIZE?

Choose first by age or usual size. The poncho has plenty of ease. Full length is measured from the top of the neckline to the hem.

Size	Age	Stitches	Width	Length	Arm opening
92	2 yr	208	ca. 61 cm	ca. 36 cm	ca. 16 cm
98	3 yr	208	ca. 61 cm	ca. 37 cm	ca. 16 cm
104	4 yr	224	ca. 66 cm	ca. 38 cm	ca. 16 cm
110	5 yr	224	ca. 66 cm	ca. 40 cm	ca. 18 cm
116	6 yr	232	ca. 68 cm	ca. 42 cm	ca. 19 cm
122	7 yr	248	ca. 73 cm	ca. 43 cm	ca. 19 cm
128	8 yr	248	ca. 73 cm	ca. 45 cm	ca. 19 cm
134	9 yr	264	ca. 78 cm	ca. 46 cm	ca. 20 cm
140	10 yr	264	ca. 78 cm	ca. 48 cm	ca. 21 cm
146	11 yr	280	ca. 82 cm	ca. 50 cm	ca. 21 cm
152	12 yr	280	ca. 82 cm	ca. 52 cm	ca. 21 cm
158	13 yr	288	ca. 85 cm	ca. 53 cm	ca. 22 cm
164	14 yr	304	ca. 89 cm	ca. 54 cm	ca. 24 cm
170	15 yr	304	ca. 89 cm	ca. 56 cm	ca. 24 cm
176	16 yr	320	ca. 94 cm	ca. 58 cm	ca. 24 cm

IMPORTANT ABOUT THE CONSTRUCTION

All sizes are knitted as one round piece. There is no side opening that is cut or knitted separately. The arm opening is only formed once a point on the front part is buttoned to a point on the back part on each side.

Try the poncho on as you go. The length can easily be adjusted before the buttonholes are knitted.

TECHNIQUES AND NECKLINE

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
rnd	round
k / p	knit / purl
inc 1	lift the strand between stitches and knit it through the back loop
stockinette in the round	all stitches knitted plain
i-cord	narrow knitted cord edge

1 - NECKLINE

Cast on with the 4.5 mm circular needle:

Size	Cast on	Rib height
92	64 m	2.5 cm
98	64 m	2.5 cm
104	64 m	2.5 cm
110	64 m	2.5 cm
116	72 m	2.5 cm
122	72 m	2.5 cm
128	72 m	2.5 cm
134	72 m	2.5 cm
140	72 m	2.5 cm
146	72 m	2.5 cm
152	72 m	3 cm
158	80 m	3 cm
164	80 m	3 cm
170	80 m	3 cm
176	80 m	3 cm

Join in the round without twisting the work. Place a clear round marker at centre back. Knit *1 knit, 1 purl* in the round until the neckline has the given height. Switch to the 5 mm needle and knit 1 plain round.

ROUND INCREASE SECTION

2 - PLACE THE MARKERS

Divide the stitches into 8 equal sections with markers. The round marker is also the first increase marker.

Size	Stitches per section
92	8
98	8
104	8
110	8
116	9
122	9
128	9
134	9
140	9
146	9
152	9
158	10
164	10
170	10
176	10

INCREASE ROUND

3 - INCREASE ROUND

Knit to 1 stitch before the marker. Increase 1 stitch leaning left. Move the marker over. Increase 1 stitch leaning right. Repeat at all 8 markers. This increases 16 stitches.

Then knit 1 whole round plain with no increases. Repeat these two rounds until the right stitch count is reached:

Size	Increase rounds	Stitches after increases	Approx. length
92	9	208	ca. 12 cm
98	9	208	ca. 13 cm
104	10	224	ca. 14 cm
110	10	224	ca. 14 cm
116	10	232	ca. 14 cm
122	11	248	ca. 15 cm
128	11	248	ca. 15 cm
134	12	264	ca. 17 cm
140	12	264	ca. 17 cm
146	13	280	ca. 18 cm
152	13	280	ca. 18 cm
158	13	288	ca. 18 cm
164	14	304	ca. 19 cm
170	14	304	ca. 20 cm
176	15	320	ca. 21 cm



TIPS: How to increase: For a stitch leaning left, insert the left needle from the front under the strand between two stitches and knit it twisted. For a stitch leaning right, insert the left needle from the back under the strand between two stitches and knit it twisted. The two new stitches then lean away from each other, giving a neat, symmetrical line out from each marker.

Checkpoint: The right stitch count matters most. If the height is off, keep knitting with no increases until the work has the given length.

KNIT ON IN THE ROUND

4 - THE WHOLE PONCHO

Remove the 7 ordinary increase markers, but keep the round marker at centre back. Knit all stitches plain in the round with no more increases. Continue until the work measures approx. 1.5 cm less than the given full length.

Size	Stop at
92	34.5 cm
98	35.5 cm
104	36.5 cm
110	38.5 cm
116	40.5 cm
122	41.5 cm
128	43.5 cm
134	44.5 cm
140	46.5 cm
146	48.5 cm
152	50.5 cm
158	51.5 cm
164	52.5 cm
170	54.5 cm
176	56.5 cm

SIDE FASTENING

5 - SIDE FASTENING

Lay the work flat with the round marker at centre back. Find the middle of each side.

Count the given number of stitches from the side middle towards the front and place a marker for the button. Count the same number of stitches towards the back and place a marker for the buttonhole.

Size	Stitches
92	14
98	14
104	14
110	15
116	16
122	16
128	16
134	17
140	18
146	18
152	18
158	19
164	20
170	20
176	20

The work is still one whole, unbroken circle. Nothing is split.

BUTTONHOLE AND I-CORD EDGE

PLACEMENT FROM CENTRE BACK

Point	Knapphull 1	Knapp 1	Knapp 2	Knapphull 2
92	38	66	142	170
98	38	66	142	170
104	42	70	154	182
110	41	71	153	183
116	42	74	158	190
122	46	78	170	202
128	46	78	170	202
134	49	83	181	215
140	48	84	180	216
146	52	88	192	228
152	52	88	192	228
158	53	91	197	235
164	56	96	208	248
170	56	96	208	248
176	60	100	220	260

6 - BUTTONHOLE

Knit to the first buttonhole marker: yarn over, k2tog. Knit to the next buttonhole marker and repeat. Finish the round. Then knit 1 whole plain round, also across the yarn overs.

7 - I-CORD EDGE

Cast on 3 new stitches on the left needle. Knit 2. Knit the next i-cord stitch together with the next poncho stitch through the back loop. Slide the 3 stitches back without turning. Repeat all round the hem. Sew the beginning and end neatly together.

The i-cord edge runs continuously all round the poncho.

FINISHING

8 - THE BUTTONS

Sew one button on securely at each marker on the front part, right above the i-cord edge. Button each one through the buttonhole on the back part on the same side. The back part lies over the front part. Weave in ends, wash gently and dry flat.

FINISHING TOUCHES

- ☐ Weave in all ends on the wrong side.
- ☐ Soak the garment in lukewarm water with wool wash. Do not rub or wring.
- ☐ Press the water out in a towel. Dry flat to the given measurements.
- ☐ Check the buttons after drying. Sew them extra securely.

Before this pattern is sold: every size must be test-knitted, measured after washing and technically checked.

Happy knitting!



Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com

© 2026 Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is for personal use only. The pattern may not be copied, shared, resold or published. Finished items may be sold on a small scale with credit to Little Montessori Explorers.